NADIA BRENNAN-AZIZ

Senior Site Reliability / Platform Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior SRE and platform engineer with 10 years of infrastructure experience, including six years operating Kubernetes platforms on AWS. Experienced in hands-on infrastructure engineering, AWS cloud environment design and operation, Terraform, platform architecture, and building reliable, observable platforms for product teams. Tech lead for a five-person platform team, with a track record of leading technical initiatives and agreeing reliability approaches with product leadership.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud infrastructure and environment operation: AWS (EKS, EC2, VPC, IAM, RDS, S3, SQS, Route 53, CloudFront), Linux
Infrastructure as code: Terraform, Atlantis
Kubernetes and platforms: Kubernetes, Helm, Kustomize, Argo CD, Crossplane, Karpenter
Reliability and observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, OpenTelemetry, SLOs and error budgets, incident management
Programming and automation: Go, Python, Bash, GitHub Actions, Puppet
Testing and capacity planning: k6

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer | Tallybrook Ltd (B2B accounting SaaS)
Manchester / remote | Apr 2022 – present

- Tech lead of a five-person platform team operating an AWS EKS platform across eight clusters and three regions, supporting approximately 350 services.
- Designed and built an internal developer platform using Go and Python service templates, Argo CD GitOps, and Crossplane self-service for RDS, SQS and S3; led the technical approach from implementation through adoption by all 14 product teams, reducing time to production from approximately two weeks to under one day.
- Introduced SLOs, burn-rate alerts and error budgets for the 20 most critical services; agreed the error-budget policy with product leadership and reduced on-call pages per week by approximately 60%.
- Led migration from cluster-autoscaler managed node groups to Karpenter, using Spot instances for stateless workloads with interruption handling. Reduced EC2 spend by 38% (approximately £410,000 per year).
- Participate in the incident commander rotation and established the incident and post-mortem process.
- Mentored three engineers transitioning from backend development into SRE.

Site Reliability Engineer | Brightwater Games
Leeds | Jan 2019 – Mar 2022

- Operated AWS game backend infrastructure using EC2, ECS and later EKS for titles with up to 1.2 million daily active players.
- Managed AWS infrastructure in Terraform (approximately 40 modules), using Atlantis for plan and apply workflows on pull requests.
- Replaced a noisy Nagios setup with a Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager and Loki observability stack.
- Used k6 for analytical load testing and launch-day capacity planning; simulated 300,000 concurrent players and identified a connection-pool limit before launch.

SELECTED PROJECT

Kubernetes preview namespace cleanup operator | Open source, 2024

- Built a small Kubernetes controller in Go using controller-runtime to delete expired preview namespaces; the project has approximately 120 GitHub stars.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science | University of the North Moors | 2016

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | 2021; renewed 2024
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional | 2023

SELECTED SPEAKING

“SLOs that product managers care about” | UK DevOps meetup | 2024

LANGUAGES

English (native) | Urdu (conversational)